trade throughout the greater part of India was quite unjustified and should not have been

put forward. Its application, successfully resisted by many of the provinces and states. . . might have led to serious catastrophies in various parts of India.'

After referring to the apathy and mismanagement of the governmental apparatus both

at the centre and in the province, the Commission say that 'the public in Bengal, or at

least certain sections of it, have also their share of blame. We have referred to the atmosphere of fear and greed which, in the absence of control, was one of the causes of the rapid rise in the price level. Enormous profits were made out of the calamity, and in the circumstances profits for some meant death for others. A large part of the community lived in plenty while others starved, and there was much indifference in face of suffering. Corruption was widespread throughout the province and in many classes of society.' The total profit made in this traffic of starvation and death is estimated at 150 crores of rupees (Rs. 1,500 millions). Thus if

there were a million and a half deaths by famine, each death was balanced by roughly a

1,000 rupees of excess profit!

green grass, and **the** blood **that** was shed feeds **the** soil and gives

strength and colour to new life. Human beings with their unique

quality of possessing memory live in their storied and remembered

pasts and seldom catch up to the present in 'The worlde that

neweth every daie.' And that present slips into the past before we